

SAE.5 : English part

Benchmarking

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Homeless Garden Project

Location: United States, Santa Cruz

[Homeless Garden Project](#) (HGP) is a non-profit organization based in Santa Cruz, California, that manages an organic urban farm. It offers vocational training, transitional employment, and support services to people experiencing homelessness. The farm produces vegetables, herbs, and flowers using regenerative agricultural practices. The products are sold via a farm stand and a Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) program. Trainees also create artisanal and value-added products sold online and locally.

The website presents HGP's mission, its programs, its community engagement, and ways to support it financially through volunteering, memberships, and donations.

Navigation is generally fluid with a dynamic presentation thanks to a good mix of texts, photos, videos, and graphic elements. The donation system, outsourced via Network for Good, is also an interesting choice as it allows the organization to rely on a specialized platform that is more secure than a homemade payment system.

However, the site could synthesize some content and prioritize information to facilitate reading. Several images also seem not to load correctly. Furthermore, the navigation has many levels of nesting, which can complicate access to certain information and confuse the reader. Finally, some URLs cover similar topics, which could be clarified by grouping or reorganizing certain contents in a more streamlined way.

Website Evaluation

Advantages	Flaws
• Fluid transitions • Mix of texts, photos, videos, and other graphic elements • Outsourced donations via Network For Good (a specialized third-party donation platform)	• Overly voluminous content • Many broken or unloaded images • Too many nesting levels in the menu (25 sub-links) • Different URLs cover similar topics

Cultivate Christchurch

Location: New Zealand, Christchurch

[Cultivate Christchurch](#) is a non-profit organization dedicated to youth development, based in Christchurch, New Zealand. It primarily targets youth with high support needs (school dropouts, social issues, mental health, etc.) and uses urban agriculture to foster self-confidence and skills development. Participants can transition from weekly volunteer sessions to an 8-week employment preparation program, which includes an NZQA-recognized horticulture qualification. The organization also contributes to local food resilience and biodiversity through its agricultural activities and partnerships.

The Cultivate Christchurch website offers a variety of content, notably including videos, images, and articles. The different sections are well separated, which facilitates navigation and understanding of the information. The warm design, with a strong presence of Mori culture, provides a visual identity that is consistent with the organization.

Nevertheless, the header occupies a significant amount of space, reducing the available area for the main content. A shorter height would better highlight the page's information. Button transitions could also be improved with light colors and highlights to facilitate reader navigation. The mobile adaptation also needs to be reviewed, as large blocks severely hinder navigation. Finally, regular site maintenance and monitoring are preferable given the presence of a few non-functional links.

Website Evaluation

Advantages	Flaws
• Varied content with videos, illustrative images, and articles • Clearly visible separation of all sections • Warm design rooted in Mori culture	• The header is too wide, leaving not enough space to read the body text • Button transitions are unpleasant • Many empty blocks in the mobile version (non-responsive design) • Some links are no longer available • PayPal button returning suspicious values (-1)

Earthworks St Albans

Location: United Kingdom, St Albans

[Earthworks St Albans](#) is a charity dedicated to social inclusion, based in the UK. It primarily supports individuals with learning disabilities (affectionately known as "Earthworkers") by offering them a safe outdoor environment to thrive. The organization uses horticulture and nature conservation to foster self-confidence and practical skill development. Participants engage in hands-on learning through ecological fruit and vegetable growing, as well as creating wildlife habitats. The charity also actively connects with the local community through the sale of its harvests and sustainability awareness projects.

The Earthworks St Albans website presents a visually adequate design with a pleasant and appropriate color palette. Navigation is supported by a functional search bar that allows users to locate specific elements across the platform, and the inclusion of a dedicated custom error page shows a good baseline of web practice.

However, the overall user experience is significantly hindered by severe performance issues, with pages taking more than two seconds to load. While the site attempts to cater to mobile users, the responsive design suffers from slight disorganization and minor layout errors, such as instances of overlapping text. Additionally, the header and footer sections feel uninspired and poorly executed. Navigation reliability is also compromised, as at least one button is broken and redirects users straight to the error page.

Website Evaluation

Advantages	Flaws
• Graphically adequate • Pleasant color palette • A custom error page is present • Search bar available (for locating various site elements)	• Terribly slow site loading times (> 2 seconds per page) • Slight disorganization with the responsive design • Some minor layout errors (overlapping text) • Header and footer are poorly executed • At least one button redirects directly to the error page

Growing Home

Location: United States, Chicago

[Growing Home](#) is a non-profit organization and urban farm based in the Greater Englewood neighborhood of Chicago. It is dedicated to providing job training for individuals facing significant barriers to employment, such as previous incarceration or homelessness. Through its paid, farm-based workforce development program, participants gain practical skills in organic agriculture and job readiness to help them secure sustainable careers. In addition to fostering personal growth, Growing Home actively works to combat food insecurity and promote food equity by cultivating USDA-certified organic produce and increasing access to healthy, affordable food within the local community.

The Growing Home website offers a modern and visually beautiful experience characterized by dynamic elements and a fully responsive design. Users benefit from fluid and clear navigation that makes exploring the site's main features intuitive and straightforward.

However, the overall experience is hindered by several notable drawbacks. There is a noticeable inconsistency in styling across different sections, particularly on the 'Stories' pages. Accessibility is a significant concern due to poor color contrast, making the site unfriendly for visually impaired users. Furthermore, the web forms are difficult to read and aesthetically unappealing. Visitors may also encounter a few technical glitches, including minor layout errors like missing images and non-functional buttons, specifically those intended to scroll through image carousels.

Website Evaluation

Advantages	Flaws
• Fully responsive design • Dynamic elements • Fluid and clear navigation • Modern and generally beautiful layout	• Inconsistent styling (especially on the 'Stories' pages) • Poor color contrast (not friendly for visually impaired users) • Forms are difficult to read and aesthetically unappealing • Some minor errors regarding images (missing assets) • Non-functional buttons (specifically for image carousels)

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